territorial disputes, the Governor-General Lord Amherst dispatched a detachment to Tek Naat, near the border on the Arakan frontier with another contingent stationed on the island of Shahpura, at the mouth of the Naat River. The Burmese claimed Shahpura as their territory and demanded withdrawal of the British garrison. The British refused and on September 23, 1823, a large Burmese force attacked Shahpura, killing three guards. On January 18, 1824, General Maha Bandula led two Burmese armies, one from Assam and the other from Manipur and attacked Cachar, which was under British protection. The British responded when Lord Amherst declared war on Burma on March 5, 1824, from his headquarters at Fort William in Calcutta.

THE FIRST ANGLO-BURMESE WAR

The first Anglo-Burmese war lasted nearly two years, costing the British nearly five million pounds and leading to the deaths of 15,000 British and Indian soldiers, as well as the deaths of tens of thousands of Burmese. The Burmese strategy was to capture Calcutta quickly using a two-pronged attack from Assam and Arakan, while the British planned to lure General Maha Bandula's forces from the Bengal frontier by attacking Lower Burma from both land and sea.

On May 10, 1824, Burmese forces under the command of General Maha Bandula entered Chittagong and offered to withdraw back to Arakan if the British handed over three Arakanese rebel leaders and a rebel Manipuri prince. Captain Cotton, the British commander at Ramu, rejected the offer. The Burmese attacked and routed a combined force of mixed sepoys (Indian soldiers) and a police detachment at Ramu following a battle that lasted three days.

Over the course of the summer of 1825, the British were successful in expelling the Burmese from Arakan despite the fact the Burmese defeated a British detachment at Ramu on the Arakan-Bengal frontier. In little more than a month General Joseph Morrison had conquered the province of Arakan and in the north, the Burmese were driven out of Assam. The British then launched two-front strategy using a 5,000-strong expeditionary force under the command of Major General Sir Archibald Campbell and ships under the command of Captain Charles Grant to attack Rangoon by